

Hiring Discussion — August 10, 2026

Attendees: Bala, Neeraj

Neeraj: Is this room booked? I thought I saw it on someone else's calendar.

Bala: I overrode it. Senior privilege. Sit down.

Neeraj: Bold. Alright what are we covering?

Bala: Hiring. Finance finally approved two headcount. One senior backend engineer and one product designer. HR wants job descriptions by end of month so they can start sourcing in September.

Neeraj: About time. We've been running lean for too long.

Bala: Tell me about it. So I want to split the work. The backend JD is yours. The last one we had was terrible, it listed technologies we stopped using three years ago. Write it from scratch, focus on what the person actually does day to day.

Neeraj: Agreed. I can have it ready by August 19th.

Bala: Good. I'll take the designer JD, I have a clearer picture of what that role needs to look like strategically. I'll get mine done by August 17th so you have it as a format reference.

Neeraj: While we're at it, can we fix the interview process too? Last time we were making up questions on the spot. Candidates could tell.

Bala: It was embarrassing. Can you put together a proper technical interview framework for the backend role? Structured questions, a scoring rubric, maybe a short take-home exercise. Something we can actually use consistently across candidates.

Neeraj: Yes, I've been wanting to do that anyway. I'll have it ready by August 22nd. Two hours max for the take-home, I don't want to waste people's time.

Bala: Agree, two hours is fair. On my end I'll put together the same thing for the designer role, a structured interview guide with a portfolio review framework. I'll have that done by August 23rd.

Neeraj: Good. Can you also get Greenhouse set up properly? We can't manage candidates over email again, the thread from the last round was genuinely unhinged.

Bala: Forty-seven replies. I counted. Yes, I'll have Greenhouse configured by August 21st. I'll also set up the pipeline stages so everything is consistent from day one.

Neeraj: That alone will save so much pain. What about salary bands? Last time finance got involved at offer stage and nearly killed two deals.

Bala: I'll work with HR and define bands for both roles before any CVs start coming in. Done by August 24th.

Neeraj: What's the sourcing strategy? Are we posting on job boards or going through a recruiter?

Bala: Job boards first, LinkedIn and a couple of others. If we don't get quality candidates in two weeks we'll bring in a recruiter. Can you draft the LinkedIn job posts for the backend role once the JD is done? The JD and the LinkedIn post are different things, the post needs to be shorter and punchier.

Neeraj: Yeah I can do that. I'll have the LinkedIn post ready by August 21st, two days after the JD.

Bala: I'll do the same for the designer role, LinkedIn post by August 19th. Oh, one more thing. The last time we hired we had no structured reference check process. We just asked whatever came to mind. Can you put together a standard set of reference check questions for the backend role? Six or seven questions, things that actually reveal something useful.

Neeraj: Sure. I'll include that with the interview framework, same deadline, August 22nd.

Bala: Perfect. How's the new analyst settling in by the way? Priya.

Neeraj: Really well actually. She's picking things up faster than I expected. She asked me a question last week that made me realise I hadn't thought properly about that part of the system in months.

Bala: Ha. Fresh eyes. Alright, let's move quickly on this. I'd love offers out before end of October.

Neeraj: Doable if we start now.

Bala: Which we are. Good talk.